with both my lawyer *and* the High Commissioner! – and we pulled up outside the Delhi police headquarters to a throng of media that made our little reception party at Mumbai airport look like a genteel Hare Krishna celebration. Peter reckons there must've easily been more than 3 000 press people there. I was hustled inside to see KK Paul, who had been my Indian nemesis for the past six years. 'Hello, Mr Gibbs,' he said. 'I'm a big fan of yours.' Not exactly the reception I had been expecting from him!

He offered me some tea, and the two of us spent the next 10 minutes talking about cricket and the interrogation that would take place later. Not that he attended that either. Here was the guy who'd basically made his career out of me – the case was high profile and often reported on in the media, which had made KK Paul something of a big deal and had resulted in several promotions for him – yet he wasn't even going to question me!

After our tea and chat, I was taken to an adjacent building – an officer's mess, I believe – where a four-man panel, headed by the joint commissioner of the Delhi Police Crime Branch, Ranjit Narayan, bombarded me with questions for about three hours. I was in a chair, with Peter behind me, and four individuals sat behind a desk facing me. It was a hostile situation, make no mistake, and it wasn't helped by the fact that I'd publicly said Commissioner Narayan was 'hard-arsed'. The commissioner wasn't happy about that at all, and he even brought it up during questioning. I had to apologise. His arse was not hard after all.

The Indian authorities had already banned quite a few of their country's players, so they were obviously taking the whole match-fixing affair seriously. It was clear from the start that they wanted to have a go at me, and they did. During the game in which I was supposed to go out for less than 20, I'd almost gone out on 18, which they were alleging was proof that I was trying to fulfil the conditions of the bribe. Ja, they were interrogating me thoroughly, to the extent that one of the guys – a tough-looking old Sikh gentleman who headed up Delhi's Murder and Robbery team – said, 'Sir, you had better come clean. We still have the death penalty here.'

Nice.

Needless to say, Peter jumped in with both feet and threatened to end the meeting right there if they tried this kind of intimidatory tactic.

While I couldn't be 100 per cent confident that the interview would turn out okay – I was in a foreign country and not sure of their agenda – I reckoned I had all my bases covered. I went into the interview knowing that